

Daily Bible Note

Date: May 25, 2026

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: 1 Corinthians 8:1–13

1 Now concerning things offered to idols: We know that we all have knowledge. Knowledge puffs up, but love edifies.

2 And if anyone thinks that he knows anything, he knows nothing yet as he ought to know.

3 But if anyone loves God, this one is known by Him.

4 Therefore concerning the eating of things offered to idols, we know that an idol is nothing in the world, and that there is no other God but one.

5 For even if there are so-called gods, whether in heaven or on earth (as there are many gods and many lords),

6 yet for us there is one God, the Father, of whom are all things, and we for Him; and one Lord Jesus Christ, through whom are all things, and through whom we live.

7 However, there is not in everyone that knowledge; for some, with consciousness of the idol, until now eat it as a thing offered to an idol; and their conscience, being weak, is defiled.

8 But food does not commend us to God; for neither if we eat are we the better, nor if we do not eat are we the worse.

9 But beware lest somehow this liberty of yours become a stumbling block to those who are weak.

10 For if anyone sees you who have knowledge eating in an idol's temple, will not the conscience of him who is weak be emboldened to eat those things offered to idols?

11 And because of your knowledge shall the weak brother perish, for whom Christ died?

12 But when you thus sin against the brethren, and wound their weak conscience, you sin against Christ.

13 Therefore, if food makes my brother stumble, I will never again eat meat, lest I make my brother stumble.

II. Key Summary

- Knowledge makes you feel more informed and freer than others; love makes you willing to give up that freedom for them
 - "Idols are nothing" is the correct understanding — but for a brother still wrestling with his conscience, that piece of meat carries more weight than just food
 - Paul lays down a clear principle: if your right to do something causes a brother to stumble, let go of that right
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III. Passage Analysis

Knowledge Puffs Up; Love Builds Up

"The difference between puffs up and edifies is striking; it is the difference between a bubble and a building. Some Christians grow, others just swell!" [1]

Knowing the right answer doesn't automatically help the people around you. Paul says love "edifies" — the original word pictures constructing a building, brick by brick. Knowledge is a tool; love gives it a direction worth following.

Your Freedom Can Be Someone Else's Trap

"It is of far more importance that your brother should not be led into sin, than it is that you should partake of meat which you acknowledge is in itself of no importance." [2]

Paul flips the usual question we ask — instead of "what's wrong with this?" he says to ask "who might stumble because of this?" The fact that Christ died for that weak brother gives his struggles far more weight than a dinner choice.

IV. Reflection Question

Is there something you do — something that feels totally fine to you — that you know makes a specific person around you uncomfortable or shaky in their faith?

If Jesus gave everything for that person too, what does that change about the choice you're about to make?

References

[1] Enduring Word, David Guzik, <https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/1-corinthians-8/>

[2] BibleHub.com, Barnes' Notes on the Bible,
https://www.biblehub.com/commentaries/1_corinthians/8-9.htm